

MINESWEEPER



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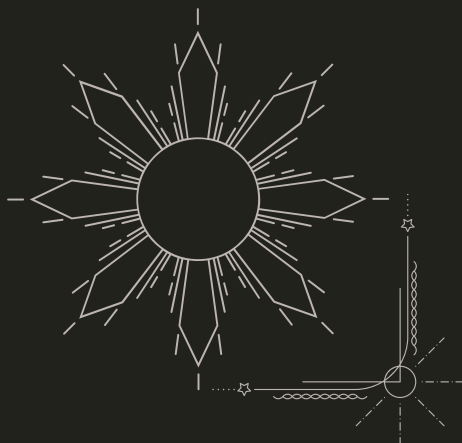
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MINESWEEPER





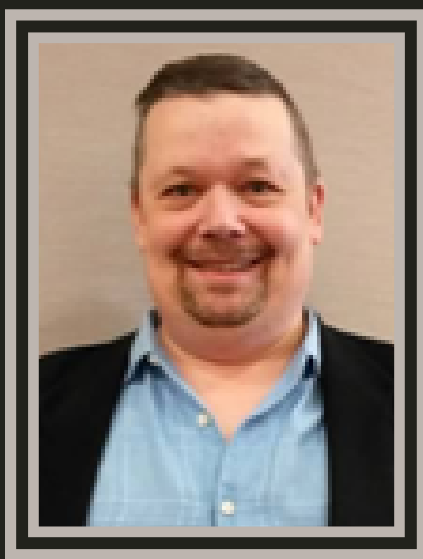
History

Minesweeper is a game developed by Curt Johnson and Robert Donner in 1990. The two of them joined Microsoft around the same time, in early 1989. Johnson was working on the OS/2 operating system for IBM. At the same time, he created the early versions of Minesweeper; the inspiration from a MacIntosh game, "Mine". In May of 1990, their game was released and named "PM Mine 2.0". Donner was credited with additional programming while Johnson was credited with original programming.

The game was then included in the Microsoft Entertainment Pack in October of 1990. It was an instant hit.



Robert Donner



Curt Johnson



objective of minesweeper

catching the mines!



2	2	1							
1	1	2	1				1	1	
2	3	1	1			1		1	
	1	1	1			1	1		
			1	1	2	2	2		
	1	1	2	1	3	1	1		
	1	1	2	2	1	4	3		
	1	1	1	1	2	1			

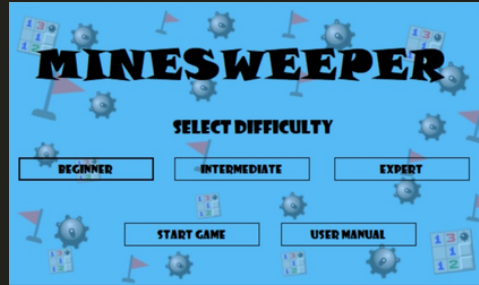
*Completed game

To win in Minesweeper, only one objective must be achieved. That is to open or clear all the cells that do not contain bombs (because the bombs are flagged). Once this goal have been completed, the game is won. In order to achieve this goal users can flag all the cells that they think are mines on the board. Lastly, the is user should try to reveal all the non-mine cells in the shortest time possible.

How to Start

Main Menu

Once you start the game, a menu screen will appear. On this menu screen, you can select the difficulty level. There is easy, intermediate and expert. Intermediate will be automatically selected if you do not select one. Once you have selected a difficulty, press "Start Game".



The Game

Once you start the game, it will automatically load a preset amount of mines in random locations. If you click on a mine, you lose! If you reveal all safe spaces, you win and a message congratulating you with an option to replay the same level or to return to the menu will appear! If you lose, you will automatically be directed to an end page. This page will display your final time.

Score System

The game will keep track of how much time elapses in each game, try to aim for the shortest time! The time lapsed is shown when you lose.



You Lose

103s

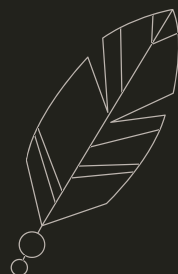
Key Controls

In minesweeper, there are only two controls. Minesweeper is controlled using the mouse; you can left click or right click,



Left Click

Left clicking uncovers a square. If the square does not contain a mine, it will display one of the numbers shown above. The number tells you how many surrounding squares contain mines. If you uncover a mine with left click, the game ends.



Good Luck!

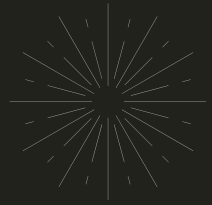


Right Click

the right click is your place flag button. You can place flags on bombs to stop yourself from losing and to know where to not click. You can also remove a flag by right clicking.



Strategies to Win!



There are many Strategies to win minesweeper,
here are a couple of them:

✓ Recognize Common Patterns

- Certain configurations of numbers and spaces often appear, which can help you quickly identify mine locations. Some common patterns include:
- 1-2-1 Pattern: If you see a row or column with this pattern, the mines are usually under the 1s.
- 1-1 Pattern: Adjacent 1s often indicate that the mine is next to both 1s."

✓ Start with the Corners

- Corners are usually the starting points because they provide fewer options, making it easier to deduce the position of mines.

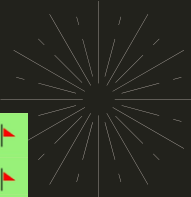
✓ Work from Known Information

- Expand from areas where you have definite information. This approach minimizes risk and maximizes the chance of safely uncovering more of the grid.



Troubleshooting

Error message popping up? Here's how to fix it!

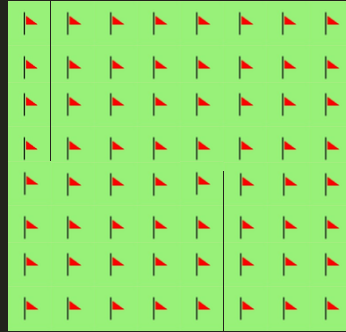


1. Too many spaces flagged!

If the flag counter is all used, and you try flag more spaces, the counter will go into the negatives! While this is completely harmless, it means that you have falsely flagged a space.

The game will not end if a "safe" space is flagged.

This can be fixed by unflagging and uncovering the space!



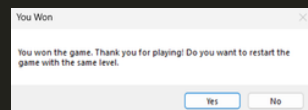
2. Game will not end

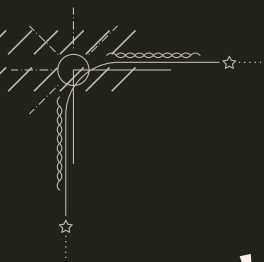
If the game does not end, then all the "safe" spots have not been revealed! Continue to reveal the spaces and the game will end automatically. Some spaces may have been incorrectly flagged! Make sure to double check all unrevealed spaces.

3. Game will not reset

If you have lost the game, after 2 seconds, it will pop up another tab, telling you how long your game was! You can press the button "Start a new game" to go back to difficulty selection.

If you won the game, a messagebox saying that you won will show up. You will have two options, either you can start a new game with the same level of difficulty or you can go to the dstart menu to change the level of difficulty..





Thank you for playing!

